

# MERIDIAN TALENT PARTNERS OOD

## Core Process Documentation — Recruitment Delivery & Operations

Internal SOP Reference v2.1 | Last Updated: March 2026 | Owner: Operations Director

### Introduction

This document describes the four core operating processes for Meridian's recruitment delivery function, produced as part of the Q4 2025 internal process audit. Adherence is mandatory for all Consultants and Researchers, though the Operations Director notes that compliance varies significantly, particularly among senior staff.

### Process 1: Mandate Intake & Brief Definition

**Owner:** Assigned Consultant | **Trigger:** Client confirms new mandate

| Step | Action                                                                                                                                            | Responsible             | Tool               | Time Est. | Quality Gate                                                            |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.1  | Receive and acknowledge brief. Confirm: title, salary, location, start date, interview process.                                                   | Consultant              | Email / Teams      | 30 min    | Acknowledgement sent within 2 hrs of receipt                            |
| 1.2  | Create mandate record in ATS (Zoho/Vincere). Complete all mandatory fields: client, role title, salary range, location, sector, source type.      | Consultant              | Zoho / Vincere     | 20 min    | All mandatory ATS fields populated — Ops Director spot-checks weekly    |
| 1.3  | Complete internal Job Brief Template. Must include: required skills, nice-to-haves, culture fit notes, deal-breakers, hiring manager style notes. | Consultant              | Word / Google Docs | 45 min    | Brief signed off by Senior Consultant or Partner before sourcing begins |
| 1.4  | Set sourcing strategy: which channels (LinkedIn, job boards, database, referrals) and in what order. Record in ATS notes field.                   | Consultant + Researcher | ATS notes          | 15 min    | Sourcing plan documented in ATS before researcher briefed               |
| 1.5  | Brief researcher (if applicable) with Job Brief Template. Schedule sourcing kick-off within 24 hours of mandate receipt.                          | Consultant              | Teams / in-person  | 30 min    | Researcher briefed within 24 hrs; logged in ATS                         |

### Process 2: Candidate Sourcing & Longlisting

**Owner:** Researcher / Resourcer | **Trigger:** Step 1.5 complete

**Known issue:** Highest-effort, lowest-automation step. Current average: 6–8 hours per mandate for initial longlist of 40–60 candidates. No AI-assisted sourcing tools in use beyond LinkedIn's native suggestions (found unreliable for specialist roles).

| Step | Action                                                                                                                                            | Responsible             | Tool               | Time Est. | Quality Gate                                                       |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2.1  | LinkedIn Recruiter Boolean search: build string from Job Brief. Review and save profiles to project. Target: 40–60 relevant profiles per mandate. | Researcher              | LinkedIn Recruiter | 3–4 hours | Longlist of min. 40 profiles saved to LinkedIn project             |
| 2.2  | Job board search (Pracuj.pl for Poland; Jobs.bg for Bulgaria; eJobs.ro for Romania; optional: Indeed EU). Download and review CVs.                | Researcher              | Job boards         | 1–2 hours | Min. 10 additional profiles from job boards documented             |
| 2.3  | Candidate database search (Zoho Recruit). Currently limited value due to data quality — most researchers spend <15 mins on this step.             | Researcher              | Zoho Recruit       | 0–30 min  | Database search recorded in ATS notes even if no usable results    |
| 2.4  | Longlist review with Consultant: review profiles, rank by fit, agree outreach priority list of 15–20 candidates.                                  | Researcher + Consultant | LinkedIn / Word    | 45 min    | Ranked priority outreach list of 15–20 candidates agreed and saved |
| 2.5  | Initial outreach (InMail, email, or phone). Personalised message referencing the role. Log all contacts in ATS immediately.                       | Researcher              | LinkedIn / Email   | 1–2 hours | All contacts logged in ATS within 24 hrs of outreach               |
| 2.6  | Track responses. Follow up non-responders after 5 business days. Update ATS candidate status after each interaction.                              | Researcher              | ATS + Email        | Ongoing   | ATS status current within 48 hrs of any contact or response        |

### Process 3: CV Screening, Formatting & Submission

**Owner:** Consultant | **Trigger:** Qualified candidates identified from sourcing

**Known issue:** CV formatting is the most time-consuming consultant-level admin task. Current estimate: 1.5–2 hours per candidate submitted. On a 5-candidate shortlist, this is 8–10 hours of Consultant time per mandate.

| Step | Action                                                                                                                                       | Responsible | Tool          | Time Est.           | Quality Gate                                                 |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3.1  | Telephone screen candidate: 20–30 min call covering motivations, availability, salary expectations, key skills validation, and cultural fit. | Consultant  | Phone / Teams | 30–45 min per cand. | Screening notes recorded in ATS within 2 hrs of call         |
| 3.2  | Obtain candidate CV and permission to represent to this client. Log GDPR consent in ATS at time of agreement.                                | Consultant  | Email + ATS   | 10 min              | Consent recorded in ATS; CV stored against candidate profile |
| 3.3  | Reformat CV to Meridian branded template (Word). Remove personal contact details, standardise font and layout, add Meridian header/footer.   | Consultant  | MS Word       | 45–60 min per CV    | CV matches current Meridian template v4 (March 2026)         |

| Step | Action                                                                                                                              | Responsible | Tool           | Time Est.             | Quality Gate                                                           |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|----------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3.4  | Write 150–200 word Candidate Summary: key skills, career narrative, why suited to this role, salary expectation, availability date. | Consultant  | Word           | 30–45 min per cand.   | Summary reviewed by Senior Consultant on exec/senior-level submissions |
| 3.5  | Compile submission pack: formatted CV + candidate summary + brief covering note to client. Send via email to hiring manager.        | Consultant  | Email / Word   | 20 min per submission | Submission pack complete per standard format; sent within 24 hrs       |
| 3.6  | Log submission in ATS. Update mandate status. Set follow-up reminder for client feedback (3 business days from submission).         | Consultant  | Zoho / Vincere | 10 min                | ATS updated same day as submission; reminder set                       |

## Process 4: Client Communication & Reporting

**Owner:** Consultant | **Trigger:** Ongoing throughout mandate lifecycle

**Known issue:** Client communication is the **lowest-rated** aspect of Meridian's service in the Q1 2026 satisfaction survey (3.1/5.0). No standard reporting template is consistently used. No client-facing portal or dashboard exists.

| Step | Action                                                                                                                    | Responsible | Tool                      | Standard Frequency                | Actual Adherence (estimated)                                                   |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4.1  | Weekly progress update to client: summary of sourcing activity, pipeline status, and market feedback if relevant.         | Consultant  | Email (ad hoc)            | Every 7 days during active search | ~40% of consultants send weekly; others update only when submitting candidates |
| 4.2  | Submission notification: email with submission pack plus context on why these candidates were selected for this brief.    | Consultant  | Email                     | Within 24 hrs of submission       | Generally adhered to — the submission triggers the email in most cases         |
| 4.3  | Interview feedback: follow up with client within 24 hrs of each interview. Log feedback in ATS against candidate profile. | Consultant  | Phone + ATS               | Within 24 hrs of interview        | Approx. 65% of interviews have feedback logged within 48 hrs of completion     |
| 4.4  | Offer management: manage negotiation between client and candidate. Log all offer stages in ATS in real time.              | Consultant  | Phone + ATS + spreadsheet | Real-time ATS logging             | Spreadsheet tracking only; ATS rarely updated in real time during offers       |
| 4.5  | Placement confirmation: confirm start date, send invoice, check in with candidate at Day 1 and Day 30.                    | Consultant  | Email + ATS               | Day 1 and Day 30 check-in         | Day 1 check-in: ~80% adherence. Day 30 check-in: ~40% adherence                |

*Process adherence data based on Operations Director spot-checks and consultant self-reporting from the Q4 2025 internal audit. Actual adherence rates are estimates; no automated compliance tracking is in place. Document version 2.1, updated March 2026.*